

From The Editor

The concept of English as a 'Technical Passport' is a pragmatic take on a historically sensitive issue. In the world of semiconductors, AI, and global supply chains, English functions less as a language and more as a primary interface for technical documentation and research. Swamy's call for 'Mission Maths' and early English fluency aims to remove the friction that currently prevents our brightest minds from participating in the global innovation economy at full throttle.

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engineering, computing, and data-driven systems. Yet, for many students, it becomes a barrier. This is not because mathematics is difficult, but because it is often taught without clarity. A deeper issue often goes unnoticed. When the medium of instruction shifts, many students struggle to follow concepts. This is frequently mistaken for a lack of ability. It is not. It is a language problem. When students are comfortable with the language, mathematics becomes accessible. When they are not, even simple ideas feel complex. There is another gap. Much of the system still follows:

Read→Remember→Apply

This works for exams. It does not build real understanding. It should be changed to:

Read→Understand→Apply

A student who understands can solve unfamiliar problems. A student who memorises cannot go beyond the textbook. Mathematics is not a collection of formulas. It is a language of patterns. When taught that way, it becomes intuitive. When not, it becomes intimidating. India needs confidence in mathematics at scale. That is what Mission Maths must deliver.

Active learning

Learning deepens when students move from passive listening to active engagement. Students learn better when they question, discuss, present, and solve problems. Three simple shifts make this effective:

- **Hands-on.** Build, test, and experiment to develop intuition
- **Outdoors.** Connect learning with

TABLE 2
FOUR ACTION PILLARS: INSTALL NOW FOR INDIA'S LEADERSHIP

Pillar	Content Focus
One Nation, One Education	Absolute proficiency in both regional language and English
Mission Maths	The foundation for the AI era
Active Learning	Hands-on, outdoors, and dialogue based
Elevate Universities	Shifting universities from administrative degree-mills to research-led hubs

real-world systems

- **Creation over coaching.** Design and build, not just prepare for exams
- Active classrooms develop confident and capable learners.

Teachers: Backbone of education

Teachers shape outcomes at every level. The quality of any education system depends on the quality of its teachers. Improving the status of teaching strengthens the entire system. This includes better recognition, competitive pay, continuous training, and performance-based growth opportunities. When teaching becomes a respected and aspirational profession, the benefits carry across generations.

Universities: Ecosystem of innovation

Universities are where knowledge is created. A strong university ecosystem:

- Builds original capability
- Attracts talent
- Contributes to global knowledge

Today, many institutions function as administrative hubs for affiliated colleges. That must change. A stronger economy requires research at scale across institutions. Affiliated colleges must move beyond teaching for exams. They need resources, autonomy, and direction to become local centres of innovation. When universities create, not just certify, capability scales.

Technology: Democratiser of learning

Technology brings scale and consistency. High-quality learning is no longer limited by geography. A student anywhere can access the same content as one in a major city. Digital and AI platforms enable:

- Uniform access to quality content
- Personalised learning pathways

Technology amplifies teachers. Scale requires access. Reliable connectivity,

affordable devices, and inclusive infrastructure are essential. When access is universal, technology becomes a true equaliser.

Employment: The survival game

Education and opportunity must grow together. For most Indian students, education is a survival game. They invest in advanced STEM only when there is a clear path ahead. That path depends on the strength of the industry. Without high-value, deep-tech industries, education alone cannot deliver outcomes. It produces degrees, not opportunity. This is the core constraint. India must move beyond the services trap. It must build strong manufacturing and core science ecosystems that can absorb and reward skilled talent. When industries grow, education aligns naturally with real-world demand. When they do not, degrees lose meaning. Employment and education are not separate. They reinforce each other.

Education: Foundation of innovation

Education forms the base of innovation and a strong, sustainable economy. A strong system builds analytical thinking, curiosity, and problem-solving skills. Innovation emerges when knowledge is applied and explored. This capability comes from strong education. Countries with strong education systems consistently build strong industries, sustain innovation, and remain globally competitive. India's path builds on its own strengths while aligning with this principle.

India has made steady progress in expanding access and building capability. The next phase requires alignment and depth (Table 2). A consistent, high-quality education system that strengthens thinking, building, and innovation will define the path ahead. **EFY**